

SENIOR CITIZENS' HEALTH PLANS

Health insurance premium rates for a 61-year-old living in New Delhi for a sum insured of ₹10 lakh

Insurer	Plans	Premium (₹/year)	Age limit (years)	Co-pay*	Pre-existing disease (years)#
1 Care Health Insurance	Senior Health Advantage	22,611	60 +	50%	2
	Care Supreme	38,784	18-98	-	4
	Care Senior	28,604	18+	20%	4
2 Star Insurance	Senior Citizen Red Carpet	26,550	60-75	30%	1
	Star Comprehensive	40,468	18-65	10%	3
	Star Health Assure	37,608	18-75	10%	30-36 months
3 Aditya Birla Health Insurance	Activ Health Platinum Enhanced	39,651	18+	-	3
	Activ Assure Diamond	34,678	18+	20%	4
4 Manipal Cigna Health Insurance	Prime-Advantage	55,161	18+	-	3
	Prime Senior Elite	50,102	55-75	20%	2
	Prime Senior Classic	46,846	55-75	20%	2
	Prime protect	42,587	18+	-	3
5 Niva Bupa Health Insurance	Health ReAssure 2.0	49,393	18-65	-	3
	Senior First Platinum	47,321	-	-	2
	Health Companion	44,226	-	-	3

PREMIUM VARIES DEPENDING ON CO-PAY AND PRE-EXISTING DISEASE COVERAGE; *CO-PAY IS THE SHARE OF CLAIM PAID BY THE INSURED; #PEDs ARE COVERED AFTER THE EXPIRY OF THE NUMBER OF YEARS GIVEN IN THE TABLE; ADITYA BIRLA HEALTH INSURANCE AND CIGNA PRIME ADVANTAGE AND CIGNA PRIME PROTECT HAVE WORLDWIDE COVER OF ₹5 LAKH **SOURCE:** POLICYBAZAAR.COM

you with maximum in-patient hospitalisation coverage, but you must also check for any deductibles or co-payment clauses,” says Singhel. But one must weigh the cost versus benefits of the policy, he adds.

Deductible: Another option is to opt for a policy with a deductible clause, where the deductible is the initial amount a policyholder must pay before the policy covers the rest of the claim. This means the insurer is only responsible for paying claims that surpass the deductible amount. For instance, if a policyholder's deductible is ₹30,000, and they file a claim of ₹1 lakh, the insurer will cover only ₹70,000. But if the claim is below the deductible amount, the insurer will not cover any expenses. Policies with higher deductibles usually have lower premiums, while

those with low or no deductibles have higher premiums.

The point to note is that health insurers sometimes impose higher co-payment, deductibles, etc., without the policyholder's knowledge. This can give you a lower premium, but it can also reduce the scope of coverage. Hence, one must check the details of the policy to ensure that co-payment and deductibles are given as per your choice.

Super Top-up: If the cost of purchasing a large health insurance policy is too high, you can consider combining a regular plan with a super top-up plan. While the regular policy covers your claim up to the sum insured, the top-up plan kicks in once a certain amount, known as deductible, has been exceeded.

It is important to note that top-up plans operate on a per-hospital-

isation basis and are useful when a single claim exceeds the deductible limit. There are super top-up plans available that consider the aggregate of claims per policy year, rather than a single hospitalisation. Due to the deductible threshold, the top-up plans have lower premiums than regular plans. And with higher deductible limits, the premiums go down. In these combined policies, the deductible must be paid either through a regular health insurance policy or out of your own pocket. “Such top-up policies are very reasonable and provide good cover against emergencies and accidents,” says Singhel.

Porting: Health insurance portability allows policyholders to port their policy from one insurer to another, especially if customers are unhappy with the service provided